

CSBA Board Policy (BP) 6142.5 Environmental Education (Revised June 2021)

CSBA NOTE: The following optional policy may be revised to reflect district practice. Pursuant to Public Resources Code 71300-71304, the Office of Education and the Environment within the Department of Resources Recycling and Recovery (CalRecycle) has developed "environmental principles and concepts," which have been adopted by the State Board of Education. For further information, see the web site of the California Education and the Environment Initiative.

The Governing Board recognizes that schools play a crucial role in educating students about the relationship between humans and the natural world and in preparing them to have the skills, knowledge, and principles needed to solve environmental problems. The Board believes that all students should understand ecological systems and the impact of human action on such systems, including, but not limited to, climate change. The district's environmental education program shall promote environmental literacy and shall prepare students to be stewards of natural resources and live an environmentally sustainable lifestyle.

The district's local control and accountability plan may include local goals and priorities for environmental literacy.

CSBA NOTE: Education Code 51210 requires the adopted course of study for grades 1-6 to include instruction on the relations of persons to their human and natural environment, the wise use of natural resources, and science instruction on the place of humans in the ecological systems. In grades 7-12, Education Code 51220 requires study of the relations of persons to their human and natural environment and science instruction that emphasizes the place of humans in ecological systems. See AR 6143 - Courses of Study.

Pursuant to Education Code 51227.3, the environmental principles and concepts must be integrated into the state content standards, curriculum frameworks, and textbook criteria in the subjects of English language arts, science, history-social science, health, and, to the extent practicable, mathematics. To date, the environmental principles and concepts have only been integrated into the science and history-social science curriculum frameworks.

The following optional paragraph reflects the content of the state-adopted environmental principles and concepts.

The district's environmental education program may be taught across the district curriculum in science, history-social science, English language arts, health, and, to the extent practicable, mathematics. Such instruction shall be aligned with state-adopted standards and curriculum frameworks and may include, but not be limited to, the interactions and interdependence of human societies and natural systems, people's dependence and influence on natural systems, the ways that natural systems change and how people can benefit and influence that change, the fact that there are no boundaries to prevent matter from flowing between systems, and the fact that decisions affecting resources and natural systems are complex and involve many factors.

CSBA NOTE: Pursuant to Public Resources Code 71300-71304, CalRecycle's Office of Education and the Environment has developed environmental education resources, including a model curriculum and successful strategies, to help districts coordinate best practices for environment-based education and environmental science and technology. Further information can be found on the California Education and the Environment Initiative's website.

The district's program may also provide for active student participation in onsite resource conservation and management programs and the promotion of service learning partnerships. The Superintendent or designee may collaborate with other local educational agencies and/or community-based organizations to enhance the curriculum and learning experiences provided to students.

The Superintendent or designee shall ensure that environment-based learning experiences are made available on an equitable basis and that the environmental literacy curriculum reflects the linguistic, ethnic, and socioeconomic diversity of California.

As appropriate, the Superintendent or designee shall provide professional development for teachers in the development and effective implementation of curriculum and activities inside and outside of the classroom that promote environmental literacy.

State References

- Ed. Code 33541 - Science requirements
- Ed. Code 51210 - Areas of study
- Ed. Code 51220 - Areas of study, grades 7 to 12
- Ed. Code 51795-51797 - School instructional gardens
- Ed. Code 60041 - Ecological systems and their protection
- Ed. Code 8700-8707 - Environmental education
- Ed. Code 8720-8723 - Conservation education service
- Ed. Code 8760-8773 - Outdoor science, conservation, and forestry
- Pub. Res. Code 71300-71305 - Statewide environmental education